

First Solar New Iberia Company History and Contacts

Executive summary

First Solar's New Iberia facility is a **greenfield Louisiana expansion** of the publicly traded parent company **First Solar, Inc.**, not a publicly documented acquisition of an older solar-panel plant. The company is a **Delaware corporation headquartered in Phoenix, Arizona**, says it was **founded in 1999**, and describes its U.S. manufacturing history as beginning in Ohio that same year. In Louisiana, the company announced the Iberia Parish project in **August 2023**, broke ground in **September 2023**, secured a publicly referenced **airport-land lease by December 2023**, began **production in July 2025**, and formally **inaugurated / commissioned** the facility in **November 2025**. The facility is now part of First Solar's five-factory U.S. manufacturing footprint. ¹

The highest-confidence site facts are these: the factory is located at **1400 Corporate Dr., New Iberia, LA 70560**; SEC filings describe the Iberia Parish property structure as **"lease land, own buildings"**; the plant manufactures **Series 7** modules using **thin-film cadmium telluride** technology in a **fully integrated, continuous process** that turns a sheet of glass into a finished module in about **four hours**; and once fully ramped the plant is expected to add **3.5 GW** of annual nameplate capacity. Public company contact routes are mostly **corporate-level** rather than plant-specific: First Solar publishes a headquarters phone number, an investor-relations email, a media-relations email, and web-form entry points for sales, HR, suppliers, support, and careers. I did **not** find a clearly published First Solar switchboard or public email specifically for the New Iberia plant on the official First Solar pages reviewed. ²

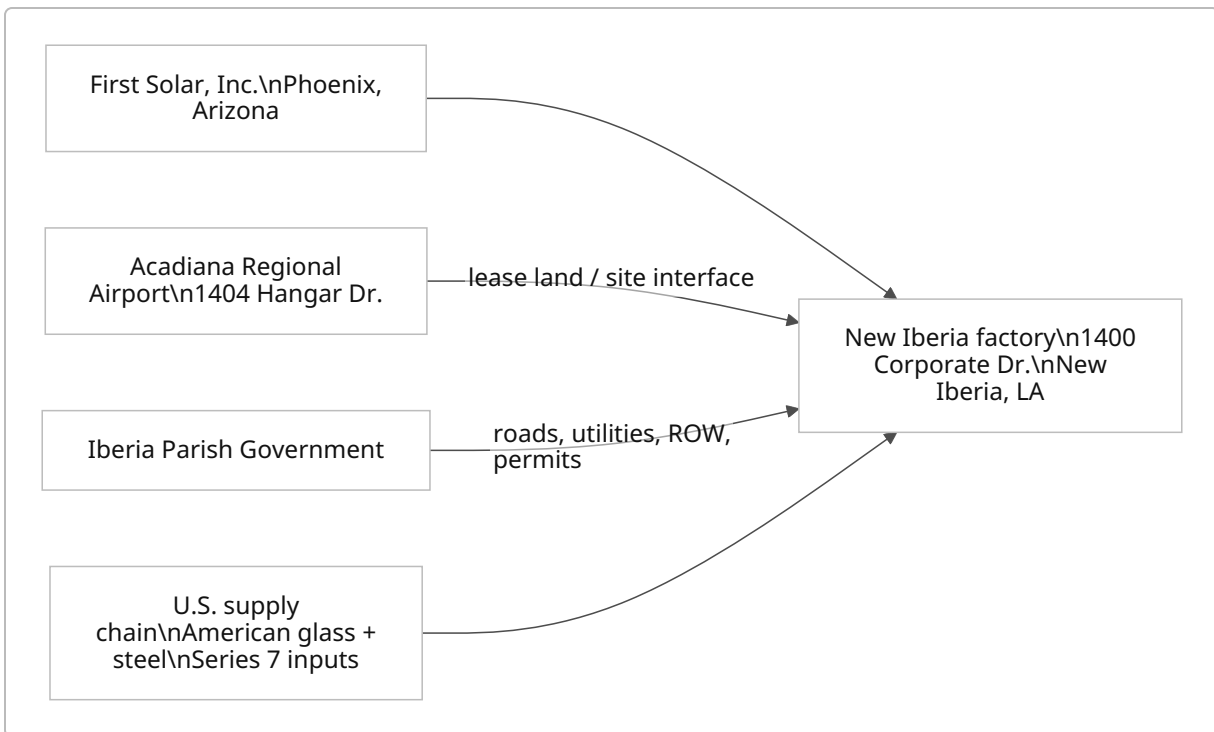
Corporate and facility profile

First Solar presents itself as an American solar technology and manufacturing company founded in **1999**, with five operational factories in **Ohio, Alabama, and Louisiana**, and a fully integrated thin-film manufacturing model that does not rely on Chinese crystalline-silicon supply chains. The company's SEC filing identifies it as **First Solar, Inc.**, incorporated in **Delaware**, with principal executive offices at **4300 E Camelback Road, Suite 220, Phoenix, AZ 85018**, and a corporate phone number of **(602) 414-9300**. ³

The New Iberia plant appears on First Solar's global locations page as the company's Louisiana manufacturing location at **1400 Corporate Dr., New Iberia, LA 70560**. In late 2025, First Solar and Louisiana Economic Development described the site as a **\$1.1 billion, 2.4 million-square-foot, fully vertically integrated, AI-enabled** manufacturing facility that had already started production and was expected to add **3.5 GW** of annual nameplate capacity when fully ramped. ⁴

Attribute	Finding	Source
Parent company	First Solar, Inc., Delaware corporation	⁵

Attribute	Finding	Source
Headquarters	4300 E Camelback Rd., Suite 220, Phoenix, AZ 85018; phone (602) 414-9300	6
Louisiana facility address	1400 Corporate Dr., New Iberia, LA 70560	7
U.S. role in corporate footprint	Fifth operating U.S. manufacturing facility	8
Product family	Series 7 U.S.-made utility-scale modules	9
Core technology	Thin-film cadmium telluride	10
Manufacturing model	Fully integrated, continuous process under one roof; roughly four hours from sheet of glass to module	11
Ramp-scale capacity	3.5 GW annual nameplate capacity when fully ramped	12



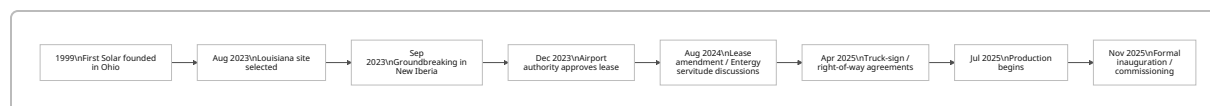
The diagram above synthesizes the documented relationship among the corporate parent, the New Iberia factory, the airport-land setting, parish-level infrastructure interfaces, and the U.S.-materials supply chain described in First Solar and local-government sources. ¹³

History and timeline

The documentary record reviewed points to a **new-build First Solar project** rather than a takeover of an existing solar-manufacturing operation. Louisiana Economic Development announced in **August 2023** that

First Solar had selected **Acadiana Regional Airport** for its **fifth American manufacturing facility**, with up to **\$1.1 billion** in investment and **more than 700** planned direct jobs. Iberia Parish then publicized a **September 21, 2023** groundbreaking ceremony. By **December 12, 2023**, Iberia Parish Airport Authority minutes recorded authorization for the chairman to sign the **First Solar lease**. Through **2024 and 2025**, local airport and parish records show continuing amendments, utility servitudes, right-of-way matters, and site-access/signage arrangements. By **July 2025** the plant had begun production, and by **November 2025** First Solar described it as inaugurated; First Solar’s economic-impact page separately describes the facility as commissioned in **November 2025**. Read together, those sources strongly suggest that **first production preceded the formal opening / commissioning milestone**. ¹⁴

Public reporting also shows the workforce ramp as part of the site’s history. A March 2025 KATC tour reported that about **300 people** had already been hired, with most from the local area and many training in **Ohio and Alabama**. By November 2025, official and local coverage said the plant already employed **more than 700** people and was expected to reach **826** by year-end. I did not locate a newer official plant-specific headcount after that point. ¹⁵



The timeline above is drawn from First Solar, Louisiana state, Iberia Parish, and airport-authority records. ¹⁶

Date	Event	What the record shows	Source
1999	Corporate founding / U.S. manufacturing origin	First Solar says it was founded in 1999 and began U.S. manufacturing investment in Ohio that year	¹⁷
Aug. 10, 2023	Louisiana project announced	Fifth American manufacturing facility; Acadiana Regional Airport selected; up to \$1.1B investment; 700+ direct jobs planned	¹⁸
Sep. 19–21, 2023	Groundbreaking publicized and held	Iberia Parish posted groundbreaking notice for Sept. 21 at 1213 Ember Drive	¹⁹
Oct. 10, 2023	Utility-financing discussion	Airport minutes discuss rededication of lease payment toward water-plant bond payments for First Solar project	²⁰
Dec. 12, 2023	Lease approved	Airport authority authorized chairman to sign the First Solar lease	²¹
Aug. 13, 2024	Lease amendment / Entergy servitude	Airport authority authorized negotiations for Entergy servitude agreement and amendment of First Solar lease	²²

Date	Event	What the record shows	Source
Nov. 13, 2024	Parish infrastructure actions	Parish notice references ROW agreements with airport authority and Entergy, a temporary laydown yard, and TIF expansion tied to a First Solar warehouse	23
Mar. 13, 2025	Workforce ramp visible	Local tour reported about 300 hires, mostly local, many training in Ohio and Alabama	24
Apr. 8, 2025	Site-access signage agreement	Airport authority authorized agreements with First Solar for truck entrance signs in right of way	25
Jul. 2025	Production start	First Solar says the facility began production in July 2025	12
Nov. 21, 2025	Formal opening	First Solar inaugurated the facility; over 700 employees, 826 expected by year-end; 3.5 GW when fully ramped	26
Nov. 2025	Commissioning language appears in official study	First Solar economic-impact page says the Louisiana facility was commissioned in November 2025	27

Ownership and site-control structure

The clearest ownership statement I found is in First Solar’s **2025 Form 10-K**, which lists the Iberia Parish property as **“Lease land, own buildings.”** That language is unusually important because it separates the site’s real-property interests into two pieces: **land control through lease** and **building ownership by First Solar**. The airport-authority minutes provide the local public-record trail that fits that description, showing a **First Solar lease** in December 2023, then later **lease-amendment** and **servitude** activity in 2024. 28

Local public records also show that the site’s development depended on parish and airport coordination for **water, utilities, right-of-way, and access**. Airport minutes in October 2023 discussed lease-payment redirection for **water plant bond payments** tied to the project. Parish records in November 2023 referenced a **cooperative endeavor agreement** for relocation of a **10-inch waterline** at the First Solar project. A November 2024 parish notice referenced **servitude and right-of-way agreements with Iberia Parish Airport Authority and Entergy**, plus a temporary laydown yard agreement, which indicates that the facility’s physical development required a wider public-infrastructure package beyond the factory footprint itself. 29

I did **not** find evidence in the primary sources reviewed of a later ownership transfer, plant sale, or an acquisition-based origin for the New Iberia manufacturing facility. The available record instead reads as a classic **greenfield project on leased airport land** with site improvements and factory buildings developed for First Solar’s own operations. That conclusion is an inference from the site-selection announcement, the groundbreaking record, the SEC property disclosure, and the airport-authority lease trail. 30

Question	What the public record shows	Source
Who controls the land?	SEC says the Iberia Parish site is on leased land	31
Who owns the buildings?	SEC says First Solar owns the buildings	31
Was there a local lease approval?	Yes; airport authority authorized chairman to sign the First Solar lease on Dec. 12, 2023	21
Were later amendments needed?	Yes; Aug. 2024 minutes reference Entergy servitude agreement and amendment of First Solar lease	22
Were parish utility / ROW arrangements part of the project?	Yes; public notices reference waterline relocation, ROW agreements, and temporary laydown-yard arrangements	32
Any documented ownership change after opening?	None found in the sources reviewed	33

Contact matrix

First Solar company contacts

Official First Solar contact information is concentrated at the **corporate level**. The company publishes a headquarters address and phone number, a dedicated **investor-relations** email, a dedicated **media-relations** email, and web routes for **sales, support, HR, suppliers, and careers**. The Louisiana locations page lists the New Iberia address, but the official pages I reviewed do **not** publish a clearly labeled plant-specific public phone number or site email for New Iberia. 34

Contact type	Public contact route	Notes	Source
Corporate headquarters	4300 E Camelback Rd., Suite 220, Phoenix, AZ 85018; (602) 414-9300	SEC-listed parent-company contact	5
Louisiana manufacturing site	1400 Corporate Dr., New Iberia, LA 70560	Official location listed; no public switchboard shown on location page reviewed	7
Investor relations	investor@firstsolar.com	Published on investor relations site	35
Media relations	media@firstsolar.com	Published on official media contacts page	36
HR / careers / support / suppliers	Official web forms and routing through First Solar contact page	Contact page routes requests by category rather than by plant office	37

Public-sector contacts that matter for the New Iberia site

For site access, land-lease context, permits, and parish coordination, the most useful public contacts are on the **Iberia Parish Government** side, especially the airport authority, permits/planning office, and parish government main office. These are often more actionable than company contacts for public-records or infrastructure questions. ³⁸

Organization	Public contact	Why it matters	Source
Acadiana Regional Airport / Iberia Parish Airport Authority	Maurice “Moe” Songy, Director; 1404 Hangar Dr., New Iberia, LA 70560; 337-365-7202; msongy@iberiagov.net	Airport-land setting, lease context, site-access interface	³⁹
Iberia Parish Government main office	300 Iberia St., Suite 400, New Iberia, LA 70560-4543; 337-365-8246	General parish contact and routing	⁴⁰
Parish President’s office	M. Larry Richard / Executive Assistant Cyndi Provost; 337-365-8246; cprovost@iberiagov.net	Parish executive office involved in project announcements and agreements	⁴¹
Permits / Planning & Zoning	Agnes Phillips-Conner; 715-A Weldon St., New Iberia, LA 70560; 337-369-4438; aphillips@iberiagov.net	Building / zoning / local permit questions	⁴⁰
Public Works / Storm Water	Jean Romero; 4018 E. Old Spanish Trail, New Iberia, LA 70560; 337-364-8474	Roads, storm-water interface, work orders	⁴⁰
Public records route	Iberia Parish website “Public Records Request” link on contact page	Best starting point for local document requests	⁴⁰

Open questions and source register

The main remaining gaps are straightforward. I did **not** find: a fully executed lease document with term and rent schedule; a clearly published First Solar New Iberia plant phone/email; or a plant-specific official headcount newer than the late-2025 “700 current / 826 expected” figures. Those are real public-data gaps, not just search gaps, and they should be treated as unresolved until confirmed through corporate or parish records. ⁴²

Source	What it contributed	Link
First Solar Overview	Corporate founding date, current footprint, technology summary	⁴³
First Solar 2025 Form 10-K	Parent-company HQ / phone, Delaware incorporation, Iberia Parish property structure	⁴⁴

Source	What it contributed	Link
First Solar Locations	Official New Iberia site address	7
First Solar Contact / Investor / Media pages	Official company contact routes	45
First Solar Manufacturing / Series 7 / CdTe pages	Facility technology, Series 7 details, continuous-process description	46
Louisiana Economic Development announcement and inauguration release	Project announcement, opening milestone, capacity, workforce, timing	8
First Solar economic-impact page	November 2025 commissioning wording and Louisiana impact context	27
Iberia Parish groundbreaking notice	Groundbreaking date and early site/location history	19
Iberia Parish Airport Authority minutes	Lease approval, lease amendment, Entergy servitude, truck-sign agreement	47
Iberia Parish public notices	Waterline / ROW / Entergy / laydown-yard / warehouse-TIF references	48
KATC and The Daily Iberian	Local buildout, hiring ramp, and opening-stage reporting	49
Iberia Parish and airport contact pages	Current public-sector contacts relevant to the site	50

1 5 6 13 28 31 34 44 <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1274494/000127449426000021/fslr-20251231.htm>

<https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1274494/000127449426000021/fslr-20251231.htm>

2 4 7 [Locations | First Solar](#)

<https://www.firstsolar.com/en/About-Us/Locations>

3 17 43 <https://www.firstsolar.com/en/About-Us/Overview>

<https://www.firstsolar.com/en/About-Us/Overview>

8 14 18 30 33 <https://www.opportunitylouisiana.gov/news/first-solar-to-invest-up-to-1-1-billion-to-build-solar-panel-manufacturing-facility-in-acadiana-create-over-700-new-direct-jobs>

<https://www.opportunitylouisiana.gov/news/first-solar-to-invest-up-to-1-1-billion-to-build-solar-panel-manufacturing-facility-in-acadiana-create-over-700-new-direct-jobs>

9 10 <https://www.firstsolar.com/en/Products/Series-7>

<https://www.firstsolar.com/en/Products/Series-7>

11 16 46 <https://www.firstsolar.com/Technology/Manufacturing>

<https://www.firstsolar.com/Technology/Manufacturing>

- 12 26 <https://www.opportunitylouisiana.gov/news/first-solar-inaugurates-new-1-1-billion-ai-enabled-louisiana-manufacturing-facility>
<https://www.opportunitylouisiana.gov/news/first-solar-inaugurates-new-1-1-billion-ai-enabled-louisiana-manufacturing-facility>
- 15 24 49 <https://www.katc.com/iberia-parish/first-solar-an-exclusive-look-inside-iberia-parishs-largest-investment-in-history>
<https://www.katc.com/iberia-parish/first-solar-an-exclusive-look-inside-iberia-parishs-largest-investment-in-history>
- 19 <https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/from-iberia-parish-president-m-larry-richard-groundbreaking-ceremony-for-first-solar/>
<https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/from-iberia-parish-president-m-larry-richard-groundbreaking-ceremony-for-first-solar/>
- 20 29 <https://www.acadianaregionalairport.com/site/wp-content/uploads/2023/11/Oct-10th-2023-Minutes.pdf>
<https://www.acadianaregionalairport.com/site/wp-content/uploads/2023/11/Oct-10th-2023-Minutes.pdf>
- 21 42 47 <https://www.acadianaregionalairport.com/site/wp-content/uploads/2024/01/Dec-12th-2023-Minutes.pdf>
<https://www.acadianaregionalairport.com/site/wp-content/uploads/2024/01/Dec-12th-2023-Minutes.pdf>
- 22 <https://www.acadianaregionalairport.com/site/wp-content/uploads/2024/09/AUGUST-13TH-2024-MINUTES.pdf>
<https://www.acadianaregionalairport.com/site/wp-content/uploads/2024/09/AUGUST-13TH-2024-MINUTES.pdf>
- 23 48 <https://louisianapublicnotice.com/notices/461314>
<https://louisianapublicnotice.com/notices/461314>
- 25 <https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/acadiana-regional-airport/minutes-april-8-2025-airport-authority/>
<https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/acadiana-regional-airport/minutes-april-8-2025-airport-authority/>
- 27 <https://www.firstsolar.com/About-Us/Economic-Impact-Study>
<https://www.firstsolar.com/About-Us/Economic-Impact-Study>
- 32 <https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/wp-content/uploads/A-2023-11-15-1.pdf>
<https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/wp-content/uploads/A-2023-11-15-1.pdf>
- 35 [First Solar, Inc., Financials - Quarterly Results](https://investor.firstsolar.com/financials/quarterly-results/default.aspx)
<https://investor.firstsolar.com/financials/quarterly-results/default.aspx>
- 36 <https://www.firstsolar.com/en/Global/Archive/Home/About-Us/Media-Contacts>
<https://www.firstsolar.com/en/Global/Archive/Home/About-Us/Media-Contacts>
- 37 45 [Contact Us | First Solar](https://www.firstsolar.com/en/About-Us/Contact)
<https://www.firstsolar.com/en/About-Us/Contact>
- 38 40 50 <https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/contact/>
<https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/contact/>
- 39 <https://www.acadianaregionalairport.com/contact/>
<https://www.acadianaregionalairport.com/contact/>
- 41 <https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/parish-president/>
<https://iberiaparishgovernment.com/parish-president/>